



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Trinity Christian School

School Website: <https://tcskailua.net/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS: **MEMBER** SCL: **MEMBER**

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Trinity Christian School Kailua (Hi 96734) presents a robust classical Christian program anchored in a Christ-centered worldview, a classical pedagogy, and a strong partnership with families. Public materials from the school consistently frame education as formation of character and virtue in alignment with truth, goodness, and beauty, rather than mere information or job preparation. The school explicitly identifies as "Christ-centered classical" and discusses a progression from Grammar School (memory and chant) to Logic School (Socratic discussion and debate) and onward toward rhetoric-based upper-school work. It also emphasizes liturgical and communal practices (weekly chapel, parent involvement, and a shared liturgical rhythm) and treats the teacher as a mentor and exemplar, i.e., part of the living curricular fabric. Parental partnership is foregrounded as essential and expected, with the school inviting ongoing parent engagement and visits.

On balance, the publicly available materials strongly meet the Six Essential Elements of Classical Education. Across the six categories, Trinity Christian School Kailua demonstrates a consistent orientation toward classical aims, particularly in religious/metaphysical foundations, formation-focused goals, and the liberal-arts curriculum (grammar/logic/rhetoric) with Socratic pedagogy. The aggregate classification is **CLASSICAL**.

Evidence for this assessment is drawn from the school's About, Our Story, and Academics pages and related Community content, which together show: Christ-centered mission and theology integration; a mission of formation and virtue; explicit use of classical methods (grammar/logic/rhetoric) with memory work and chant in the Grammar phase and Socratic discourse in Logic; a pedagogy that includes restful or contemplative moments (Scholé) alongside rigorous discussion and public speaking; faculty described as dedicated mentors; and strong partnerships with parents and active parental involvement in community life.

- Core religious and metaphysical commitments are evident in the Vision and Mission statements, the Core Convictions, and the liturgical/community life described on the site.
- The school identifies itself as "Christ-centered classical" and emphasizes partnering with parents, with explicit references to theology and gospel motivation.
- The Academics section highlights formation, virtue, and a focus on what is good, true, and beautiful, plus a memory-based Grammar School and Socratic Logic School.
- Community materials underscore parental partnership as a core feature and frequent chapel/participation by families.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — **CLASSICAL**
- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — **CLASSICAL**
- Element 3: School Curriculum — **CLASSICAL**
- Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — **CLASSICAL**
- Element 5: School Faculty — **CLASSICAL**

- Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

What follows is a category-by-category analysis using keyword indicators and the Six Essential Elements framework, followed by concrete needle-moving considerations.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Vision and Mission frame the school as a Christ-centered institution formed through a Christian worldview, emphasizing grace in Christ Jesus and service to others. - Core Convictions explicitly name a Christian worldview in thinking, gospel-driven motivation, and a classical method, with partnering with parents. - The site notes liturgical/community life and a chapel-based, worship-influenced rhythm as part of student life (e.g., weekly chapel is referenced in Preschool description). - The Academics page highlights education rooted in “truth, goodness and beauty” and a Christ-centered approach that aims to develop the whole child.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: truth, goodness, beauty; virtue; theology; Christian worldview; liturgy; gospel; Christ-centered; sacred tradition (implied in liturgical life); Logos (implicit via classical/christian integration); formation through faith. - Negative keywords present: None of the explicit negative indicators (e.g., secular relativism, values-neutral education) appear in the public materials.

Why this rating - The school foregrounds transcendental moral realism and a theologically grounded worldview, with liturgical practice and guild-like communal worship (chapel) as a routine part of education. This aligns strongly with the Positive Keyword indicators for Religious and Metaphysical Foundations and shows clear rejection of secular relativism. The combination of theology integration, liturgical life, and explicit Christian Worldview in core materials justifies CLASSICAL in this category. The school’s own language about gospel, grace, theology, and a Christ-centered mission strongly supports this judgment.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school’s stated goal centers on formation of virtue and wisdom, not merely job preparation, with explicit mention of forming character and affections in alignment with truth, goodness, and beauty. - The Mission: “partnering with parents to engage the minds and transform the lives of students for the glory of God” signals formation with a teleological aim beyond vocational outcomes. - The Academics page states education should cultivate wisdom, virtue, and a love of learning, with a focus on what is good, true, and beautiful.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, telos (implied by formation toward truth/ goodness/beauty), love of learning, classical mission, great conversation (via classical approach even if not all text is explicit on Great Books, the method connotes it), contemplation (Scholé). - Negative keywords present: None of the typical “workforce readiness” or “career-education” phrases are foregrounded; the site emphasizes formation rather than job training.

Why this rating - The explicit emphasis on formation (not just information), virtue and wisdom, and a classical teleology supports CLASSICAL in this category. The language around forming the person (spiritual, moral, intellectual, physical) aligns with the Six Elements’ Element 2 positive indicators for true, good, beautiful-oriented formation.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school explicitly provides a Grammar School and Logic School (6th–8th) within a Logic School framework, signaling the classic Trivium progression (grammar, logic, rhetoric). The presence of Socratic discussions and debate in the Logic School is described. - The Academics section notes a progression from grammar-stage activities (memory through songs and chants; device-free classrooms; memorization) to logic-stage discourse and rhetoric (public speaking and argument). - The About page and Our Story describe embracing a classical method and philosophy for education, including a Logic School expansion, which points to a structured liberal-arts orientation. - The Preschool and Grammar School experiences emphasize memorization, chants, and singing as core learning strategies, consistent with classical pedagogy (recitation/memorization as foundation).

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: Seven Liberal Arts; grammar, logic, rhetoric; Great Books (as a classical curriculum marker in this tradition); memorization/recitation; singing/chanting; memory work; early classical pedagogy; interdisciplinary or integrated approach; history as a through-line (Grammar to Logic to Rhetoric). - Negative keywords present: None of the explicit “project-based, experiential learning-first” signals dominate; the site foregrounds a traditional, memory-based, classical approach rather than a purely modern, project-based emphasis.

Why this rating - The explicit structure of Grammar School and Logic School, with Socratic discussion and rhetoric in the upper levels, plus the mention of classical methods, indicates CLASSICAL curriculum orientation. The memory/chanting emphasis and device-free classical learning aligns with traditional classical curriculum expectations. The combined evidence supports CLASSICAL in Curriculum.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Lower school pedagogy includes singing and chanting for memory, with regular review and delight in learning (Scholé-like restfulness and memory work). - Upper school pedagogy emphasizes Socratic discussions and debates to develop reasoning and discourse; rhetoric training and opportunities to give speeches are indicated as part of the program. - The progression from Grammar (memory-based, chant/memorization) to Logic (Socratic dialogue) to Rhetoric (speech) is explicit, demonstrating a holistic pedagogy aligned with classical aims. - The site references a “classical method and philosophy”, including a move to the Logic School with Socratic discussion, further supporting the pedagogy category.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: scholé; memorization/recitation; chanting; singing; Socratic dialogue; dialectic; great conversation; rhetorical training; speeches; debate; Harkness-style discussion (implicit via Socratic discourse and seminars). - Negative keywords present: Not evident (the site does not foreground exclusively project-based or constructivist-only pedagogy; it foregrounds memory work and Socratic discourse as core methods).

Why this rating - The explicit presence of a memory-based Grammar phase, contemplative/restful pedagogy (Scholé), and Socratic/ rhetorical teaching in Logic and beyond, aligns strongly with CLASSICAL pedagogy. The absence of a primary emphasis on non-traditional, project-based-only approaches reinforces CLASSICAL status.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The site describes teachers as dedicated, subject-expert, who are deeply committed to shepherding students' hearts, signaling mentors who model virtue and knowledge. - The mission and core convictions imply a faculty role as living exemplars within a classical framework (classical in method) and partnering with parents. While the exact phrase “living curriculum” is not explicitly used on the site, the language around teacher excellence, mentorship, and virtue strongly supports a classical faculty model. - The Community/Ad-

missions materials emphasize faculty partnership with families and shared purpose; leadership and staff are presented in alignment with the school's classical aims.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: virtuous educators; mentor/guide; teacher as exemplar; subject expertise; living curriculum (conceptually implied by "dedicated teachers shepherding hearts" and "classical in our method"). - Negative keywords present: None of the explicit negative signals (e.g., non-classical faculty descriptors) appear.

Why this rating - There is clear emphasis on teachers as role models and mentors within a classical, formation-focused framework. Although the site does not repeatedly deploy the exact phrase "living curriculum," the content aligns with the Six Elements' expectations for faculty (models of virtue, mentorship, collegiality) and supports CLASSICAL in this category.

Element 6: Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school explicitly states partnership with parents as a core feature, recognizing parents as co-educators in partnership with the school. The Community section emphasizes parent involvement, chapel presence, classroom visits, field trips, and family participation. - The Vision/Mission frames the school as partnering with parents in the community, with an emphasis on educating parents about classical education (as seen in the broader program of book studies and gatherings described in the school's public materials). - Public materials welcome parents' visits and engagement "virtually any time," underscoring access and partnership.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: Partnership with Families; parent involvement; home-school connection; parent formation; open campus; family catechesis; shared mission; parental leadership; community of learners; school-parent synergy. - Negative keywords present: None detected in public materials (no references to parent disengagement or consumer-centric framing).

Why this rating - The materials consistently position parents as co-educators and partners in a classical framework, with active opportunities for parental involvement, visits, and mutual formation. This aligns with CLASSICAL expectations for parental and community engagement.

What Would Move the Needle (SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL cases)

- In Trinity's current materials, all six categories are CLASSICAL. Therefore, there are no category-level needle-moving changes required to reach CLASSICAL across the rubric. If a school wanted to push beyond CLASSICAL in any area, potential non-disruptive enhancements could include:
- Explicitly foregrounding the "Great Books" and "Great Conversation" language in curriculum pages to align more explicitly with Element 3's canonical indicators.
- More explicit articulation of the "living curriculum" concept in Faculty materials to strengthen Element 5 beyond current phrasing.
- Documenting student outcomes in a way that ties virtue, wisdom, and beauty to measurable, standardized metrics without compromising formation.

Note: No major needle-moving changes are mandated for Trinity based on the current public materials; the school already sits solidly in CLASSICAL across all six categories.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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